FREIGHT SKILLS

DRAYAGE OPERATIONS

Drayage Checklist.

Ask better questions. Build a clearer quote. Keep the container move organized.



LUIS URIBE

Practical skills. Better freight businesses.

CHECKLISTS / QUOTE TEMPLATES

01 / BEFORE YOU REQUEST A RATE

Get the details in one place.

Use the original nine-point checklist to establish the shipment scope before you request a carrier rate. Record unknowns and assign someone to confirm them.

01 Import or Export

02 Drop & Pick or Live Load/Unload

03 Size of the Container (40/20/HC/GP)

04 Weight of the Container (Gross Weight)

05 Commodity (What is inside the container)

06 Hazardous or Non Haz?

07 Pickup Location (Terminal/Port or Warehouse)

08 Delivery Location (Terminal/Port or Warehouse)

09 Expected Date of shipment

> **MAKE THE WEIGHT CLEAR**
>
> When someone gives you a weight, confirm whether it is cargo weight or the loaded container gross weight. Keep the unit of measure with the number.

02 / CARRIER COMMUNICATION

Request the rate and availability.

Quote Request Template

Hello, My name is xxx from xxx logistics. I wanted to see if you can provide a rate and availability for the following container move.

1. Expected Date:

2. Pickup at:

3. Delivery To:

4. Container Size:

5. Container Weight:

6. Hazardous or Non Haz:

Please let me know your rate and soonest availability.

Thank you

> **MAKE THE ANSWER USABLE**
>
> Ask the carrier to identify what the rate includes, what is excluded, the applicable accessorials, and how long the quote remains valid. Keep the written reply with the shipment record.

Carrier / contact / quoted rate / quote expiry

03 / CUSTOMER COMMUNICATION

Present the quote clearly.

Quote to Customer

Hello,

Pleased to offer the following quote:

Basis on:

[Size of container]

[Weight of container]

[Pick up Port] - [Delivery Location]

EST Arrival:

Charge	Original template
Drayage	XXX$
Fuel	XX%
Chassis	$XX Per day / Minimum 2 Days

Includes 2 hours free at port and delivery. $85/hr thereafter

> **ILLUSTRATIVE TERMS, NOT A CURRENT RATE SHEET**
>
> The two-day chassis minimum, two free hours and $85 hourly amount above are the original teaching examples. Confirm the actual carrier terms and replace these examples before sending a quote.

04 / QUOTE CONDITIONS

Make the assumptions visible.

Original quote disclaimer

* Due to severe congestion a congestion fee may apply at certain terminals to be disclosed at time of booking

* We or our carriers are not responsible for per-diem under any circumstances. All charges must be cleared prior to pick up.

> **REVIEW BEFORE REUSE**
>
> The original wording is retained for reference. Do not assume a blanket per-diem disclaimer changes your obligations. Have the terms you actually use reviewed for your contracts and operating circumstances.

Add these checks to the working file

Confirm the terminal, container availability, last free day and release status with the appropriate parties. Record who supplied each detail and when.

Confirm chassis availability and the empty-return location and instructions. Ask about any appointment, pre-pull, storage, waiting-time or special handling requirement that could affect the quote.

Keep a written record of assumptions and changes. Reconfirm the rate and timing if the shipment scope changes.

Open item / person responsible / confirmation needed

05 / EQUIPMENT REFERENCE

Container specifications

Original reference figures. Weights in kg; dimensions and door openings in m; capacity in m3. Actual equipment varies - confirm the container and movement requirements.

Dry Cargo Containers

Size	Gross	Tare	Net	Length	Width	Height	m3
20 ft	24,000	2,370	21,630	5.898	2.352	2.394	33.20
40 ft	30,480	4,000	26,480	12.031	2.352	2.394	67.74

Door openings: 20 ft: 2.343 W × 2.280 H; 40 ft: 2.343 W × 2.280 H.

Refrigerated Containers

Size	Gross	Tare	Net	Length	Width	Height	m3
20 ft	24,000	3,050	20,950	5.449	2.290	2.244	26.70
40 ft	30,480	4,520	25,960	11.690	2.250	2.247	57.10

Door openings: 20 ft: 2.276 W × 2.261 H; 40 ft: 2.280 W × 2.205 H.

Open Top Containers

Size	Gross	Tare	Net	Length	Width	Height	m3
20 ft	24,000	2,580	21,240	5.629	2.212	2.311	32.00
40 ft	30,480	4,290	26,190	11.763	2.212	2.311	65.40

Door openings: 20 ft: 2.330 W × 2.263 H; 40 ft: 2.330 W × 2.263 H.

06 / EQUIPMENT REFERENCE

Container specifications / continued

Original reference figures. Weights in kg; dimensions and door openings in m; capacity in m3. Actual equipment varies - confirm the container and movement requirements.

Flat Rack Containers

Size	Gross	Tare	Net	Length	Width	Height	m3
20 ft	30,480	2,900	27,580	5.624	2.236	2.234	27.90
40 ft	34,000	5,870	28,130	11.786	2.236	1.968	51.90

High Cube Containers

Size	Gross	Tare	Net	Length	Width	Height	m3
40 ft	30,480	3,980	26,500	12.031	2.352	2.698	76.30
45 ft	30,480	4,800	25,680	13.544	2.352	2.698	86.00

Door openings: 40 ft: 2.340 W × 2.585 H; 45 ft: 2.340 W × 2.585 H.

SOURCE VALUE FLAGGED FOR REVIEW

The original 20 ft Open Top net value is 21,240 kg. Its listed gross (24,000) minus tare (2,580) equals 21,420 kg. The source value is preserved here; verify the specification before using it.

07 / PUT IT TO WORK

Container-move readiness sheet

Use one sheet per move. A blank field is a follow-up task, not an assumption.

Container / booking reference / import or export

Pickup terminal or facility / delivery location

Availability / last free day / appointment / release status

Loaded gross weight / cargo / equipment / handling

Carrier / chassis / empty return / rate and accessorials

Outstanding item / owner / next action

YOUR NEXT STEP / FREE COMMUNITY

Keep learning. Keep moving.

Join the free FreightSkills community on Skool.

Put this guide to work alongside people who understand the freight business. Bring your questions, share what you are learning, and keep building your skills.

01 **Guidance from Luis**

Ask questions and get input from Luis in community discussions.

02 **Support from other members**

Compare notes, exchange ideas, and learn from the challenges other freight professionals are working through.

03 **Stay current with new content**

Keep up with the latest FreightSkills lessons, resources, and content announcements.

04 **First dibs on giveaways**

Get early notice of our giveaways and opportunities to take part.

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